Likewise, the sudden discovery of a taped telephone conversation between Prabhakaran and his political adviser Anton Balasingham sent shockwaves through the security agencies. In the conversation, Prabhakaran is heard telling Balasingham that Rajiv Gandhi should be 'fixed' once he (Prabhakaran) gets off Indian soil. It was June 1985 when Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi had Prabhakaran as a visitor at his 7, Race Course Road residence. The R&AW had chosen New Delhi's prestigious Ashoka Hotel for Prabhakaran's stay. The LTTE supremo had come with his military chief Mahathaya and Balasingham. The meeting took a dramatic turn even before it could start. When Prabhakaran and his companions arrived at the security-check area at Rajiv Gandhi's residence, the security staff raised objections to the trio entering, since they had cyanide capsules hanging around their necks. While cyanide capsules were mandatory for marked LTTE cadres to avoid arrest, the Special Protection Group (SPG), specially created for protecting the Prime Minister, could not allow anything around the Prime Minister that could pose a potential threat to his life.

A commandant of the elite force asked them to remove the capsules. Mahathaya and Balasingham obliged but Prabhakaran refused. He was not ready to take off something that worked for his protection. Prabhu Chawla wrote in his story in *India Today*,

> SPG and the IB feared that the mercurial leader could use the lethal capsule to kill Rajiv Gandhi. An IB officer tried to persuade Prabhakaran, but the rebel leader simply refused to budge. A compromise was reached. Prabhakaran could wear the cyanide capsule, but he would be escorted by two SPG guards to ensure that he made no sudden moves. Rajiv Gandhi was kept at a certain distance from him. The SPG joined two tables together to ensure that Prabhakaran would never come within handshaking distance of Rajiv Gandhi.[6]

The episode had soured Prabhakaran's mind even before the meeting could begin. A former diplomat and a loyalist of the Gandhi family, Natwar Singh,